

Education, University, Schools, Policies, Campus Life

1. Do you agree or disagree with the statement that the most important lessons can't be learned in a classroom. (4)
2. Some teachers prefer students to send questions about coursework and assignments by email. Other teachers prefer students ask these questions in person. Which do you think is better? Explain why. (6)
3. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? It is important for all university students to engage in social activities such as joining clubs or sports groups. Use details and examples to explain your answer. (15)
4. Some students who study abroad prefer to live with roommates from the same cultural background. Others prefer to live with roommates from different countries. Which would you prefer and why? (18)
5. Some college students take classes during the summer. Others take the summer off from school, so that they can rest or work at a job. Which do you think is better for students? Explain why. (19)
6. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? Schools that encourage students to be creative and use their imagination produce the most successful students. Use details and examples to explain your opinion. (23)
7. Some university students participate in clubs or activities in addition to doing schoolwork. Other students spend most of their time doing schoolwork and do not participate in extra activities. Which do you think is better and why? (26)

8. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? Good teachers admit when they have made a mistake or do not know something. Use a specific example to support your point of view. (29)

9. Your university is organizing a series of guest lectures. Some people think that speakers with controversial opinions should not be invited to speak at the university. Others believe that the university should feature variety of speakers, regardless of their opinions. Which point of view do you agree with? Explain why, using details and examples in your response. (31)

10. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? It is better for students to live with a roommate who is studying the same subject. Use details and examples to explain your opinion. (35)

11. Some recent university graduates choose to spend a period of time doing volunteer or community service before they start their careers. Others think it is better to start working as soon as possible after graduation. Which view do you agree with? Use details and examples to explain your answer. (36)

12. Some students like having a teacher who supervises them closely and frequently checks their work. Others prefer having a teacher who lets them work on their own and only occasionally checks their work. Which do you prefer? Explain why. (44)

13. Imagine that you need to find housing next semester and have found two possible apartments. The first apartment is within walking distance to campus, but the rent is a little expensive. The second apartment is farther away from campus, but the rent is more affordable. Which apartment do you think is better? Explain why. (50)

14. Some people believe that doing homework is not helpful for younger children and that it should be given only to older students. Others believe that homework should be assigned to children of all ages. Which point of view do you agree with? Use details and examples to explain your opinion. (49)

15. Some universities expect students to choose a major field of study when they enter university. Other universities allow students to wait until the second or third year before deciding on a major field of study. Which do you think is better? Why. (57)

16. Some people believe that every college student should be required to take maths classes. Others believe that only those who need it in their future careers should be required to study maths. Which point of view do you agree with? Use details and examples to support your answer. (58)

17. Imagine that you need to find housing next semester and have found two possible apartments. The first apartment is within walking distance to campus, but the rent is a little expensive. The second apartment is farther away from campus, but the rent is more affordable. Which apartment do you think is better? Explain why. (61)

18. Your university is planning to require all first-year students to take a class in which they would learn how to use the resources available at the university library and apply those skills in writing a long research paper. Do you think this is a good idea? Explain why or why not, using specific examples and details. (63)

19. When giving a lecture to a small class, some professors prefer to wait until the end of class to answer student questions. Other professors will stop at different points during the lecture to answer questions. Which style do you think is best for learning? Explain why. (64)

20. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? Students who are physically active and exercise regularly are more likely to succeed academically. Use details and examples to explain your opinion. (66)

21. Because most students have their own laptops, your university is considering closing the campus computer lab, where students use university-owned computers. Do you think this is a good idea? Explain why or why not, using details and examples in your response. (71)

22. To help ensure students have enough time for studying, your school is considering placing a limit on the number of student clubs, sports, or organizations that a student is allowed to join. Do you think this is a good idea? Explain why or why not, using specific details and examples in your response. (72)

23. Many universities require all first-year students, regardless of their field of study, to take a writing or composition course in which they write several essays on a variety of topics. Do you think this is a good idea? Explain why or why not. Use details and examples to explain your opinion. (79)

24. The local elementary school in your area has decided to make a change to their science program. Instead of children performing experiments themselves, in science class, they will now watch demonstrations of science experiments on videos. Do you think this is a good idea? Why or why not? Use details and examples in your response. (83)

25. Some high schools require students to take music and art classes. Other schools do not require such classes. Which do you think is better for students and why? (84)

26. Some people think that participating in class discussion should be part of the grade students receive for a class. Others think that students should be graded only on written assignments, such as research papers and tests. Which do you think is better and why? (85)

27. Your university is considering a policy in which professors will only be eligible for promotions and pay raises if they have received positive evaluations of their teaching from students. Do you agree with this policy? Explain why or why not, using specific examples and details. (91)

28. It is the policy of many universities that parents of university students cannot have access to their child's grades without their child's permission. Do you agree or disagree with this policy? Use details and examples to explain your opinion. (93)

Friends and Social Life

1. Some people enjoy having friends drop by for an unplanned or surprise visit. Others prefer that friends let them know in advance before coming to visit. Which do you prefer? Explain why. (27)

2. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? It is important to help people who have moved into your neighborhood to feel welcome and part of the community. Use details and examples to explain your answer. (40)

3. When watching movies and television shows with friends and family, some people prefer that everyone remain quiet until the end. Other people enjoy talking and sharing opinions during the movies and shows. Which do you prefer? Explain why. (56)

4. Some people enjoy participating in performances such as theatrical plays or musical concerts. Others prefer to be in the audience watching the performance. Which do you prefer? Use reasons and details in your response. (52)

5. Nowadays, some people use extreme methods, including surgery, to change their appearance usually because they are trying to look more attractive in some way. Do you think this is a good idea? Explain why you agree or disagree with people using such methods to change how they look. Support your opinion with details. (59)

6. Some people like to organize and plan parties or other social events. Others prefer not to organize parties and would rather simply attend events that they have been invited to. Which do you prefer? Use details and examples to explain your opinion. (65)

7. When visiting an art museum, some people prefer to go with their friends or colleagues and discuss the works of art. Others prefer to go alone so they can view and think about the works of art by themselves. Which do you prefer? Explain why. Give specific details and examples in your response. (67)

8. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? Students who are physically active and exercise regularly are more likely to succeed academically. Use details and examples to explain your opinion. (76)

Family, Parents and Children

1. Some people prefer to spend time by themselves while others prefer to spend time with their family. Which do you prefer? Explain why. (9)

2. Some people like to face challenges by themselves. Others prefer to have help from another person when they face a difficult situation. Which do you prefer and why? (11)

3. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? It is important for child's development to spend short periods of time living away from home visiting other relatives or friends. Use examples and details to support your opinion. (20)

4. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? Children should be encouraged to watch or listen to the news from an early age. Use details and examples to explain your opinion. (43)

5. Do you agree or disagree : Children should be required to help with household tasks as soon as they are old enough to do so. Please use specific reasons and examples to support your answer. (45)

6. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? Children need to learn at an early age how to be independent. Use details and examples to explain your answer. (69)

7. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? Parents should not read their children's text messages and emails without their permission. Use reasons and details to explain your opinion. (70)

8. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? Parents should discourage their children from pursuing careers in competitive fields where success is not likely, such as professional sports or entertainment. Use examples and details to explain your answer. (77)

9. Some people think that parents should help children solve their problems. Others think that children should learn to solve problems on their own. Which point of view do you agree with? Explain why, using details and examples. (82)

10. Some parents think they should protect their children from making mistakes. Other parents think it is best to allow children to make their own mistakes. Which view do you agree with? Use specific examples and details in your response. (86)

11. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? Playing sports as children encourages people to become overly aggressive later in life. Use details and examples to explain your opinion. (89)

Jobs, Part-time Jobs, Work Environment, Projects, Schedule

1. Do you agree or disagree that university students should have part-time jobs? Why? (8)

Some people prefer to work in an office; others prefer to work from home? Which do you prefer and why? (10)

2. Some people prefer jobs that require them to work mostly with computers and other technology. Others prefer jobs that do not require them to work with much technology. Which type of job would you prefer? Why? (14)

3. Some people prefer to work in an office setting. Others prefer to work from their home away from the traditional office or workplace. Which of these two work arrangements would you prefer and why? (17)

4. Companies have started giving their employees extra free time during the workday to socialize or engage in non-work activities. The theory is that this will increase

productivity over time. Do you agree with this theory? Explain why or why not, using details and examples. (30)

5. Some people believe that businesses should be required to spend a certain amount of their profits on social programs that benefit the public and the communities where they operate. Others believe that businesses should be able to decide for themselves how spend their profits, which contribute you agree with. Use details and examples to explain your opinion. (34)

6. Recently some companies have started giving their employees extra free time during the workday to socialize or engage in non-work activities. The theory is that this will increase productivity over time. Do you agree with this theory? Explain why or why not, using details and examples. (37)

7. Some people prefer to work in a company where they have the independence to complete tasks and work out solutions to problems on their own. Others prefer to work in an environment where they are told exactly what they need to do. Which work situation would you prefer and why? (54)

8. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? A boss or manager should not form close friendships with his or her employees. Use details and examples to explain your answer. (60)

9. Some people prefer to shop for groceries at specialty shops such as butcher shops and bakeries. Others prefer to shop for everything at once at a supermarket. Which do you think is better and why? Use details and examples to support your answer. (68)

10. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? To be successful in life, sometimes, you have to make enemies. Use details and examples to explain your opinion.(78)

11. A large corporation wants to hire a new leader to run the business. It is considering two highly qualified candidates who have different approaches to decision making for the job. The first person has a reputation for acting quickly and not always consulting with others before making decisions. The second person is known for sometimes delaying decisions in order to consider other people's opinions. Who do you think would make a better leader? Explain why, using details and examples. (81)

12. Imagine you have been offered two jobs. One job pays a very high salary but requires you to work very long hours and weekends. The other job pays a lower salary but does not require you to work outside of regular business hours. Which job would you choose? Explain why. (88)

13. Some people choose a profession that will allow them to work independently. Others choose a profession that will allow them to work as part of a group. Given a choice, which kind of profession do you prefer and why? (90)

Government, Country and City Policies/Problems

1. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? Government should enact a law to fine those people who use cellphones while walking across a street. Use specific reasons and examples to support your position. (46)

2. Some people believe that a country's government should give money to support arts institutions like museums or theaters. Others feel that it should not be the role of governments to do this. Which opinion do you agree with? Explain why (48)

3. Some people think that, when moving to a new country, they should adapt to the cultural habits and traditions of the new country. Other people prefer to keep their original habits and traditions. Which point of view do you agree with? Explain why, using details and examples in your response. (51)

4. Your city is considering a proposal to require car owners to pay an additional fee if they drive cars that do not meet environmental standards set by the city for air pollution. Do you think this is a good idea? Explain why or why not. Support your opinion with specific details and examples. (73)

5. Some people believe that a country's government should be responsible for the health of its citizens and should regulate the sale of unhealthy food and drinks. Other people believe that individuals should be free to make their own decisions about what they consume. Which view do you agree with? Use details and examples to explain your answer. (74)

6. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? People should spend time reading the news every day in order to know what is happening in other countries around the world. Use details and examples to explain your opinion. (87)

Technology

1. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? Technology distances people from each other more than it brings them together. Use specific examples and details to support your opinion. (13)

2. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? The increasing number of different resources on the Internet has actually made it more difficult to find reliable information. Use specific details and examples to support your opinion. (80)

3. When traveling in an unfamiliar place, some people prefer to use smartphones or other navigational devices to get around and find places. Others prefer to explore on their own and ask others for directions when necessary. Which do you prefer? Use details and examples to explain your preference.(94)

Entertainment and Personal Interests, Celebrities, Exercise and Social Media, Hobbies

1. Some people prefer to watch entertainment TV programs; others prefer to watch educational programs. Which do you prefer? Explain why. (1)

2. Do you prefer listening to recorded music or going to live music performances? Explain why. (3)

3. Some people like to listen to music on headphones while they go from one place to another. Others prefer going from place to place in silence. Which do you prefer? Explain why. (12)

4. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? Newspapers are a better source of information about current news events than television is. Use details and examples to explain your opinion. (16)

5. Some people like to buy used books including textbooks whenever they are available. Others prefer to buy only new books. Which do you prefer and why? (21)

6. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? Use details and examples to explain your opinion. Popular celebrities such as musicians, actors, and athletes are good examples for young people to follow. (22)

7. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? Nowadays, for a business to be successful, it must be actively involved in social media. Use details and examples to explain your opinion. (33)

8. Some people like to read certain books more than once. Others prefer to always read something they have never read before. Which do you usually prefer? Explain why, using details and examples. (38)

9. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? People should only engage in activities or hobbies at which they are good or talented. Use details and examples to explain your answer. (39)

10. When watching movies and television shows with friends and family, some people prefer that everyone remain quiet until the end. Other people enjoy talking and sharing opinions during the movies and shows. Which do you prefer? Explain why. (41)

11. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? Because of the increasing popularity of entertainment technology fewer people are taking the time to read books for pleasure. Use details and examples to support your opinion. (53)

12. Some people enjoy participating in performances such as theatrical plays or musical concerts. Others prefer to be in the audience watching the performance. Which do you prefer? Use reasons and details in your response. (55)

13. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? Watching television is not a good use of time. Use specific examples and details to support your opinion. (95)

Environment: Concerns and Issues

1. Imagine that you live in a crowded city with only one green space-the city park. To address the issue of overcrowding the city council has proposed building a new housing complex on this last space in the city center. Do you think this is a good idea? Explain why or why not. (32)

2. Imagine that you live in a crowded city with only one green space-the city park. To address the issue of overcrowding, the city council has proposed building a new housing complex on this last green space in the city center. Do you think this is a good idea? Explain why or why not. (62)

Miscellaneous- Agree/ Disagree

1. Do you agree or disagree that people will read less in the future. Give examples and details in your answer. (7)

2. When we meet new people we tend to notice certain things about them. Do you think that these first observations tell you a lot about the person or that it takes a long time to know what a person is like? Please include specific details in your explanation. (24)

3. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? Good luck is as important as hard work in achieving success for a person's career. Please explain why in details and examples. (28)

4. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? Older doctors are more knowledgeable than younger doctors. Use specific examples and details to support your opinion. (42)

5. Some people believe that our personalities change as we grow older. Others think that our personalities stay the same from childhood. Which view do you agree with and why? Give specific details to explain your answer. (75)

Preferences

1. Some think that natural talent and ability are more important for an athlete; others think that hard work is more important. What do you think? (2)

2. Some people prefer shopping in large shopping malls; others prefer shopping in smaller shops. Which do you prefer and why? Use details in your response. (5)

3. Some people are willing to spend a lot of money on a vacation so they can do something special. Others prefer to spend very little money on their vacations. Which do you think is better? Why? (25)

4. Some people prefer to spend their extra money on objects, such as clothes or electronics. Other people prefer to spend it on experiences, like vacations or concerts. Which do you prefer and why? (47)